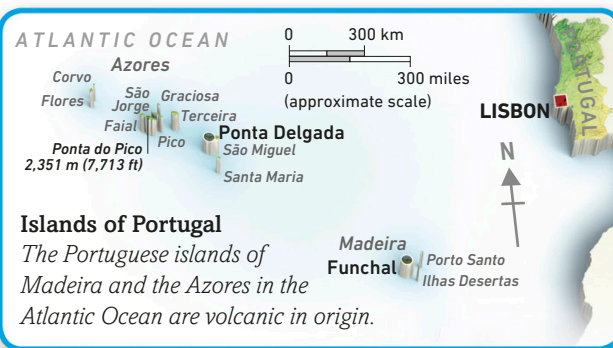




Islands of Portugal

The Portuguese islands of Madeira and the Azores in the Atlantic Ocean are volcanic in origin.

Casa da Música

The unique Casa da Música concert hall opened in the city of Porto in 2005. It can hold an audience of about 1,300 people.



The building has sharply angled concrete walls.

Decorative tiles
Glazed ceramic tiles known as azulejos are often used to decorate buildings. Most are blue, and some depict scenes from Portuguese history, such as on this wall at Porto's São Bento Railway Station.

Prince Henry the Navigator helped launch Portugal's "Age of Discovery."



Monument to the Discoveries

This famous monument on the seafront in Lisbon honors key figures from Portugal's "Age of Discovery," a period starting in the 15th century when explorers, mapmakers, and scientists voyaged over oceans to find unknown lands.

Portuguese rooster

According to local legend, roosters are considered lucky. Painted figurines of roosters are sold as souvenirs.



Palácio da Pena

This brightly colored royal castle sits on a hill overlooking the town of Sintra, to the west of Lisbon.



Geography: Portugal has more than **500 miles (850 km)** of **coastline**. It is **rocky** in the **north**, with most **farmland** in the **south**.



History: Once a **global empire**, the **monarchy** was deposed in a **revolution** in **1910**, and Portugal became a **republic**.



Culture: Portuguese traditions include **fado music**—melancholy songs accompanied by guitars—and **popular festivals**.



Natural wonders: The **Grutas de Mira de Aire caves** near Leiria and **Madeira's laurel forests** stand out for their beauty.



Wildlife: **Iberian wolves** and **lynx** roam the mountains, and **wild boars** and **deer** the countryside. **Dolphins** swim the Atlantic waters.



Food and drink: Portugal is famous for its **sweet custard tarts** and **seafood dishes**, such as **salt cod** and **grilled sardines**.